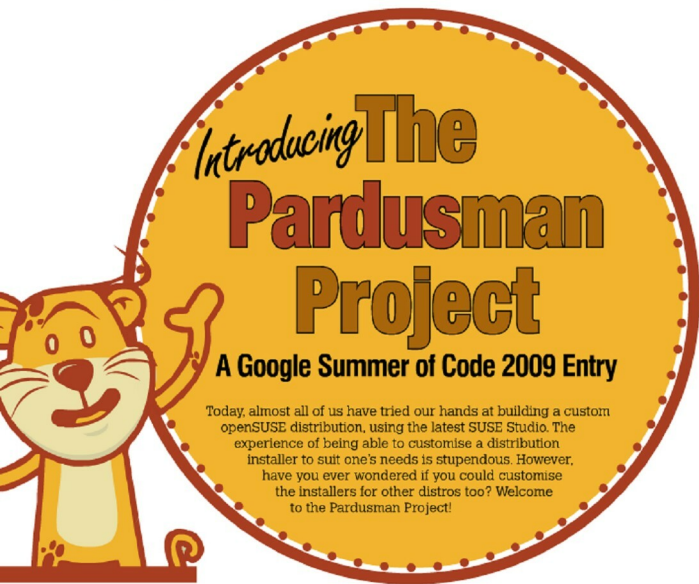




A Google Summer of Code 2009 Entry

Today, almost all of us have tried our hands at building a custom openSUSE distribution, using the latest SUSE Studio. The experience of being able to customise a distribution installer to suit one's needs is stupendous. However, have you ever wondered if you could customise the installers for other distros too? Welcome to the Pardusman Project!

Google Summer of Code (GSoC) is one of Google's important programmes that encourages open source development and contribution. This event, first held from May to August 2005, is an annual programme. Through these few months every year, Google awards stipends to hundreds of students who successfully complete free and open source coding projects that have been requested for. The programme is open to students aged 18 and above.

Although it's dubbed the Summer of Code, I would say it's more about passion than code. A piece of code is just a written expression of the passion, anyway.

Being a student developer, it means a lot

to us when speaking about our Summer of Code experience. Every year, Google selects around 1,000 student developers, from around the world, assigned to different open source projects. See code.google.com/soc for more.

This was my second GSoC. In 2008, I participated in a Fedora project. And in 2009, I worked with the Pardus Linux project. Pardus is a nicely built and user-friendly GNU/Linux distro from Turkey, developed and maintained by TUBITAK (The National Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey). My project was to create a Web-based ISO image creation tool for Pardus and I was mentored by Ekin Meroglu, core developer and project administrator, Pardus Linux Project.